

Introduction

Silver (Chemical symbol-Ag) is a brilliant grey-white metal that is soft and malleable.

Silver's unique properties include its strength, malleability, ductility, electrical and thermal conductivity, sensitivity, high reflectance of light, and reactivity.

The main source of silver is lead ore, although it can also be found associated with copper, zinc and gold and produced as a by-product of base metal mining activities.

Secondary silver sources include coin melt, scrap recovery, and dis-hoarding from countries where export is restricted. Secondary sources are price sensitive.

Demand and Supply

In 2011, the worldwide silver fabrication demand was 876.6 million ounces (Moz)—down by 1.5% from the value in 2010, but still reaching its second highest level since 2000.